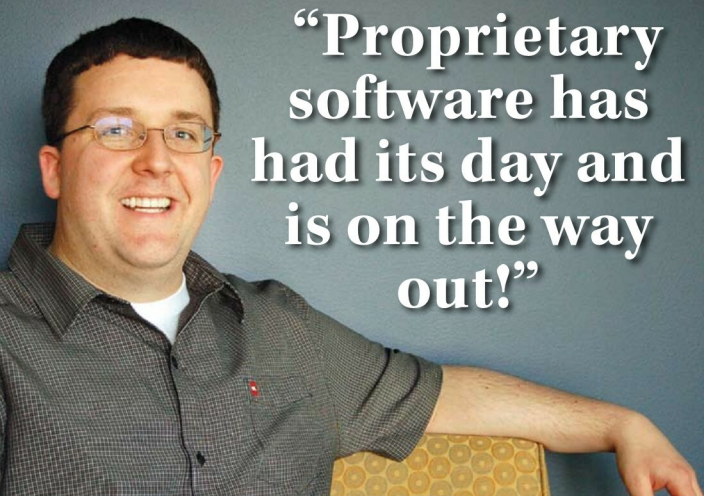




Paul W. Frields has been a Linux user and enthusiast since 1997, and joined the Fedora Documentation Project in 2003, shortly after the launch of Fedora. As contributing writer, editor, and a founding member of the Documentation Project steering committee, Paul has worked on guides and tutorials, website publishing and toolchain development. He also maintains a number of packages in the Fedora repository. In February 2008, Paul joined Red Hat as the Fedora Project Leader. Naturally, on the occasion of the 10th release of Fedora, we decided we needed the Project Leader's insight into what goes inside the project. So, here's Paul for you...

Q How and when did you realise that FOSS was something you were really interested in?

I had been using FOSS professionally for a few years as a forensic examiner. Then I started teaching it to others as a means of both saving taxpayer money, and producing results that could be independently verified, since the code was open and available to anyone. Also, if there were problems, frequently we could discover the reasons behind them and resolve them ourselves. I was really fascinated with the idea that all

this great software was produced by people who, in many cases, hadn't ever met in real life, collaborating over networks simply in pursuit of better code.

Q So what is your opinion on proprietary software?

Proprietary software is probably only useful in very niche cases—cases where the overall body of knowledge about whatever the software does is very rare or hard to obtain. For general-purpose uses, proprietary software has really had its day and is on